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Product & Platform Plan · v5

Build before you need to.

Prepared	March 2026
Model	Solo operator. Two products. One bridge. One equity vehicle.
Horizon	90-day bridge → 12-month product revenue
Constraint	Solo, primary focus on IDist. No VC. No team.
Monthly target	$20–25K/month. Advisory as bridge, products as destination.

1. What We Are Really Solving

Not a publishing problem. Not a technology problem. Not a personal branding problem.

The displacement happening right now is unlike previous economic disruptions because it hits the layer that has always felt safe: knowledge work, professional expertise, credentials accumulated over decades. The person who spent twenty years becoming genuinely good at something is discovering that the proof of that goodness lives entirely in someone else's system — a job title, a company name, a LinkedIn profile. When that system shifts or disappears, they are left trying to prove who they are to people who don't know them, with evidence that belongs to a company that no longer employs them.

The first layer of verification is always: yourself.

Before anyone else can know who you are, you have to know. Before you can sign your name to something publicly, you have to have built the private record that tells you the signature is true. This is not confidence as performance. It is conviction as infrastructure — the internal architecture that makes the external signal trustworthy.

The gatekeeping and siloed suffering inside organizations is not accidental. It is structural. People who have built careers inside institutions often have no portable proof of what they actually know — their expertise lives in access-controlled systems, covered by NDAs, attributed to company work product. They can see another job being the same situation at lower pay. They can feel the walls closing. And the advice they receive is almost always outward-facing: update your LinkedIn, network harder, build your personal brand. None of it addresses the real problem, which is that they have not yet built anything that is verifiably theirs.

The answer is not outward performance. It is inward construction first. Six to twelve months of signing your name to a domain — consistently, honestly, without an audience — creates the verifiable record that makes every outward signal trustworthy. It draws opportunities to you

rather than requiring you to chase them. It is the opposite of “putting yourself out there” while under someone else’s NDA.

> *Verification over marketing. This is the thesis. Every platform, every tool, every product in this document exists to serve this one principle. The person who publishes under their real name on their own domain, consistently, over time, with provenance infrastructure that timestamps every claim — that person is doing something no algorithm, no AI, and no platform can replicate or extract.*

Build before you need to.

This is the through-line. It is how you felt when Google featured you before anything was built. It is how every person watching their industry shift is feeling right now. The answer that is not ‘learn to code’ or ‘become an influencer’ or ‘get certified in AI.’ It is: sign your name to a domain, build something real on it, and let it compound before disruption forces the question.

Your domain is your universal income infrastructure. The machines can do many things. They cannot generate the trust that comes from a specific person having consistently showed up under their real name, with real stakes, over real time. That trust is the product. Everything else is infrastructure.

2. The Business — Stripped to What’s Real

Two products. One bridge consulting slot. One equity vehicle. That is the entire business. Every product that appeared in earlier versions of this document that is not on this list is deferred until these are proven.

Product 1	Build Before You Need To — The System · $497 one-time
Product 2	Conviction Publishing Layer · $897/year
Bridge	Advisory / consulting · 1 slot · $10,000/month
Equity vehicle	IDist / NYCID · 80% of available time

> *What is not here: a GCP starter kit, an enterprise MCP connector product, an enterprise compliance positioning, a six-product suite. Complexity was the problem, not the solution. These may be revisited after Products 1 and 2 are proven and the bridge slot is filled.*

3. Product 1 — Build Before You Need To: The System

$497 one-time · Private GitHub repo + comprehensive guide

The complete sovereign publishing stack for an individual. One opinionated path. Every decision already made.

The emotional problem this solves

The buyer is not looking for another tool. They are looking for proof that building something for themselves is possible before they need it to be. They have expertise worth preserving. They are not going to become an influencer. They do not have the budget or appetite for a startup. They need a domain that is theirs, with income capability, built on infrastructure they own, before disruption forces the question.

The system exists to answer the question they cannot quite articulate: where do I start? Not with a content strategy. Not with a brand identity exercise. With a terminal, a domain, and a weekend.

One path. No tiers.

This product offers one path: self-hosted, sovereign, fully owned. There is no Ghost Pro option, no managed hosting tier, no 'easier version.' That is not an omission — it is the product.

The reason: the offline intelligence layer (Obsidian, Ollama, Louvain), the provenance sidecar that signs every post, and the Claude Code publishing workflow require server access that managed hosting does not provide. The moment you choose managed hosting, you lose the components that make this different from simply buying a newsletter tool. Ghost Pro is a fine product. It is not this product.

Ghost is the CMS layer inside the system — the same way SQLite is the database layer. It is an implementation choice, not the brand. Ghost is MIT licensed, stewarded by a non-profit, takes 0% of revenue, and is the best tool for this specific job. That reasoning is documented in the guide. The buyer is not choosing between tools. The buyer is installing a system where the choices have already been made and justified.

> *Prerequisite: This system requires comfort with a terminal and Claude Code. If you have never run a command-line instruction, start with the Claude Code getting-started guide linked in the repo README. The first hour of the system teaches you to use Claude Code. That skill is worth more than the system itself.*

What's included

Infrastructure layer

- GCP Compute Engine e2-small setup — complete install script, Ubuntu 24.04, Ghost CLI, automated
- Ghost 6.0 installation and DNS configuration — SSL via Let's Encrypt, automated renewal
- SQLite database — Ghost native default, no Cloud SQL required, Cloud Storage backup script

- Email delivery setup — choice of Mailgun or Brevo with step-by-step guide for each
- Payment integration — choice of Lemon Squeezy or Stripe with decision framework
- Ghost Admin API + Claude Code publishing workflow — draft in Claude, post lands in Ghost as draft, review and publish

Provenance layer

- GPG key generation guide — cryptographic authorship established in under 30 minutes
- Ghost publish webhook — every post auto-commits to your private GitHub repo with GPG-signed timestamp
- llms.txt template — machine-readable map of your domain, manually maintained as corpus grows
- JSON-LD Person + Article schema — correct author attribution when AI systems cite your work, not the platform's

Content architecture

- Three-layer content model: Public (SEO + LLM indexed) → Free member → Paid ($897/year)
- Foundation post structure — the first 7 posts that give subscribers immediate value on day one
- Conviction writing framework — the quality threshold that replaces publish-or-perish pressure
- Content calendar logic — a cadence built around a single question: would you sign your name to this?

Private intelligence layer

- Obsidian vault structure — daily capture, git-synced, the raw material before anything is publishable
- Ollama local model setup — private corpus queries on your own hardware, zero tokens sent anywhere
- Louvain graph script — weekly topic cluster analysis, tells you what to write next without creating pressure to write it

72-hour onboarding sequence

- Hour 0–2: Hosting choice confirmed, domain pointed, Ghost live at yourdomain.com
- Hour 2–6: Email delivery configured, test send verified from @yourdomain.com
- Hour 6– end of Day 1: Payment integration connected, free membership working
- Day 2: Provenance layer live — GPG key generated, webhook configured, first signed commit
- Day 3: First post published, free member capture working, private intelligence layer installed
- Weekend complete: sovereign publishing stack live, income-capable, fully owned

Payment and email delivery: the decision framework

Lemon Squeezy vs Stripe

	Lemon Squeezy
What it handles	Merchant of record — EU VAT, US state sales tax, all international compliance handled for you
Take rate	5% + payment processing
Recognition	Growing fast, less consumer-facing brand recognition
Best for	Solo operators building first income layer who want tax handled
Recommendation	Default choice for this system

Mailgun vs Brevo (email delivery)

	Mailgun
Free tier	100 emails/day (36,500/year)
Setup	API-based, slightly more technical, excellent deliverability
Best for	Technical operators comfortable with API configuration
Both provide	Custom @yourdomain.com sending address, DKIM/SPF verification, delivery analytics

Cost of ownership — honest numbers

Component	Monthly cost
GCP Compute Engine e2-small	$12–15
Ghost CMS	$0
SQLite database	$0
Email delivery (Mailgun/Brevo)	$0
Payments (Lemon Squeezy)	5% of revenue only
Analytics (Umami self-hosted)	$0
Analytics (Plausible)	$9

GitHub	$0
Ollama + local models	$0
Total fixed monthly cost	Under $15

> *Compare: Beehiiv starts at $49/month before you have a single paying subscriber. Substack takes 10% of all subscription revenue forever. A Squarespace site costs $23/month and gives you no income infrastructure at all. The sovereign stack costs less than any extraction alternative at every revenue level.*

Why $497 and why it sells

$497 is below any meaningful decision threshold for the buyer this product is built for — a technical operator, consultant, or professional who can see the disruption coming. It is under the cost of one month of Beehiiv. Under the cost of one bad freelance project. What it delivers is the infrastructure to never be at zero again: a stack buildable in a weekend, owned forever, answering to no platform.

The differentiator is that every decision is already made. The buyer is not evaluating tools or configuring options. They are installing a system. That is what no tutorial, course, or template pack provides. The system costs $497 precisely because someone else absorbed the complexity of figuring it all out.

> *Delivery: Private GitHub repo access via Lemon Squeezy. Repo invite triggers automatically on purchase. No auth infrastructure to build. No support ticket system required.*

The Anthropic + GCP angle

This product is a live working demonstration of Claude Code as a real publishing workflow tool and GCP as a sovereign infrastructure layer. It is a more credible Anthropic partnership artifact than any enterprise pitch deck — it shows real people using Claude Code to build something that is genuinely theirs. That is aligned with Anthropic's actual mission in a way that an MCP connector product is not.

3b. "Can You Build It For Me?" — The Complete Answer

This question will come. It arrives in two forms: "can you host it for me?" and "can you build it for me?" Both need a clear, pre-decided answer — not because the requests are unreasonable, but because saying yes to the wrong version creates a business with a completely different character from the one being built here.

"Can you host it for me?"

The honest redirect: Ghost Pro handles managed hosting well at $29/month. This system is built for operators who want to own the full stack. The prerequisite statement on the product page ("requires a terminal and Claude Code") should filter most of these requests before purchase. For those who slip through: a kind redirect to Ghost Pro is the right answer, not a retainer.

What not to offer: a managed hosting retainer. Three clients with CI/CD responsibilities is a small managed hosting operation. Five is a distraction from IDist. Ten is unsustainable alone. The math sounds appealing in isolation — $2,500 setup + $300/month × 12 = $6,100/year per client — but ten GCP projects means ten potential 11pm Ghost installs breaking during a dependency update, ten people who think of you as their infrastructure, and a business character that is the opposite of what is being built here.

"Can you build it for me?"

This is often not "build it instead of me" — it is "I am intimidated by the path." These buyers may be exactly right for the product; they just need a different on-ramp. The answer is a "done with you" implementation session, not ongoing managed work.

Done with you: Implementation session · $1,500–2,000 one-time

A single 3–4 hour working video call. The buyer installs the system; you narrate and guide. They do the commands. You provide the judgment. They finish the session with a live sovereign stack they own, understand, and can maintain. Not consulting. Not ongoing. One session, one outcome, they leave with everything.

The distinction matters: you are not building it for them, you are building it alongside them. They finish knowing how to update, extend, and maintain it themselves. This is a finite scope at a premium price that teaches the Claude Code skill in context and produces a result they genuinely own. It does not create maintenance dependency.

Limit: 2 sessions per month maximum. Fully schedulable. No on-call. No follow-up support obligations. If questions arise after the session, they are answered in the next month's free member brief or in the system documentation — not in a direct support channel.

Vetted implementer list (future state)

Once the system has been installed by enough buyers to identify 2–3 people (likely from the GDG community) who understand it deeply: a vetted implementer list on the product page. No referral cut, no coordination overhead. "If you prefer someone to set this up for you, these people know the system." The scalable answer to "done for you" that requires zero ongoing involvement.

The self-maintaining architecture — designed into the system from day one

The system is designed so that 95% of "maintenance" is handled automatically or requires a single monthly command. This is not a feature added to reduce support burden — it is the architecture that makes buyer sovereignty real. A system that requires ongoing expert intervention is not a sovereign system; it is a dependency.

Four components handle 95% of what "maintenance" actually means for a Ghost install on an e2-small:

- Ghost CLI — 'ghost update' runs monthly in under 60 seconds, handles all Ghost version updates
- Ubuntu unattended-upgrades — OS security patches applied automatically, configured at setup, runs silently forever

- Certbot auto-renewal — SSL certificates renew automatically 30 days before expiry, zero intervention required
- Cloud Storage backup cron — nightly SQLite backup runs without touching anything, recoverable in minutes

The system documentation includes a one-page monthly maintenance section that is genuinely: open terminal, run ‘ghost update’, done. Plus the three most common failure modes and exactly how to fix each. That is not ongoing maintenance — that is a capable adult managing a simple server they own. If they cannot manage that, Ghost Pro is the correct product for them.

Optional: Annual health check · $250–300

A scheduled 45-minute video call, once per year. Not on-call. Not CI/CD. Review the setup together, run ‘ghost update’ if they haven’t, answer any questions that have accumulated. Fully schedulable, low overhead, reinforces the relationship without creating operational dependency. At 20 buyers per year: $5,000–6,000 for roughly 15 hours of scheduled, non-urgent work. Only offered once the system documentation is stable enough that the call is genuinely 45 minutes and not triage.

The complete answer to “can you build/host it for me?”

Request	Answer
“Can you host it?”	No. Ghost Pro handles managed hosting at $29/month. This system is for operators who want to own the stack. Kind redirect, no apology.
“Can you build it?”	“Done with you” session at $1,500–2,000. One call, one outcome, they own everything. Not ongoing. Max 2/month.
“Can you maintain it?”	No retainers. The system maintains itself. Monthly ‘ghost update’ is the buyer’s only obligation. Optional annual health check at $250–300 if they want a touchpoint.
“I don’t do terminals”	The system teaches Claude Code as part of the install. If that is genuinely not possible: Ghost Pro. The product delivers sovereignty, and sovereignty requires engaging with the tooling.

4. Product 2 — Conviction Publishing Layer

$897/year · Annual only · No monthly option
Access to ongoing thinking from someone who is actually doing it, in real time, with skin in the game. No ads. No sponsors. No extraction.

What subscribers are paying for

Not posts. Not content. Not a newsletter. Access to a specific person who has built five businesses from zero, is building a sixth right now in public, and is thinking clearly about disruption without selling anything except the subscription itself.

The feeling it creates in the reader is: I am not alone in this, and there is a way through it. That feeling is what $897/year buys. It requires trust. Trust requires that the person behind it has skin in the game, no hidden incentives, and is genuinely figuring it out alongside the reader rather than performing certainty they don't have. Every platform that has ever existed structurally destroys this trust because the incentive is always one step removed from the reader. A personal domain does not.

People are not tired of reading. They are tired of being marketed to while they read. The subscription is the only revenue model here. No affiliate links. No sponsors. No 'this post is brought to you by.' That absence is itself the product differentiator.

What's included at $897/year

Full archive access	Every post, every piece, no metering. All content from day one of the paywall opening.
Foundation library	7 curated posts delivered immediately on subscribe. New subscribers get value from minute one, not dripped over months.
Depth posts	2–3 per month of substantive synthesis not available on the public layer. Quality threshold: would you pay $75 to read this?
Annual State of the Stack	One major yearly artifact: a synthesis of the AI/tools landscape from someone actually building in it. The document a technical operator would pay $500 for elsewhere.
Working notes access	Excerpts from the private corpus. Imperfect, honest, occasionally unfinished. The thinking before it becomes content.
System discount	50% off the Build Before You Need To system ($248.50). Included automatically in the welcome sequence.
Grandfathering	Price increases as corpus deepens. Existing subscribers locked at their entry price permanently.
No ads, no sponsors	No affiliate links. Ever. The subscription is the only revenue model.

The three content layers

Layer 1 — Public (free, SEO, LLM-indexed)

2 posts/month. No gate. Written for discovery and for the LLMs that will increasingly be the discovery mechanism. These answer specific questions someone might ask an AI about building from zero, evaluating AI tools, or navigating conviction under uncertainty. Quality threshold: would a stranger pay $20 to read this?

Layer 2 — Free member

Weekly brief. Email required, no paywall. The trust-building layer. Short, honest, occasionally uncomfortable. This is where the voice develops before the corpus justifies charging for it.

Layer 3 — Paid ($897/year)

The depth layer. 2–3 longer posts per month. Working notes. Annual synthesis. Full archive. The content that only gets published after the question ‘would you sign your name to this?’ has an honest answer.

> *Paywall timing: Do not open the paid layer until you have read back through six months of writing and would pay for it yourself. Estimated: month 4–6 from first post. 50 subscribers at $897 = $44,850/year. 100 = $89,700. The economics work at small scale because the price is honest.*

The private intelligence layer that makes it compound

Obsidian vault

Daily capture. Working notes. Pivots documented as they happen. Git-synced to a private repo — every thought has a provenance timestamp before it becomes content. The raw material before anything is publishable.

Ollama + local model

Llama 3.1 8B or Qwen2.5 14B running locally on your own hardware. Your vault embedded with a local model, stored in SQLite. Private queries against your own archive — zero tokens sent anywhere. Optional overlay: the publicly available works of the mentors whose thinking you carry (Robbins, Tolle, Diamandis, Goggins, Novagratz, Master Stephen Co) as an indexed reference layer. Their frameworks applied to your specific decisions, in private, interrogated by your own history.

Louvain graph

Python script running weekly over your tag/topic graph. Identifies which topics cluster together, where you are writing densely versus sparsely, and which posts sit at cluster boundaries — your most original synthesis points. Navigation tool, not publishing mechanism. Run locally, zero cost, output as JSON.

5. The Bridge — Advisory Slot

1 slot · $10,000/month · Not consulting — advisory
The financial bridge while the product layer builds. One client. Tight scope. Right price.

Who the right client is

Not an enterprise compliance team. Not a regulated industry buyer who needs educating on your framework. The right client is a technical founder or senior operator building a production AI system on GCP or with Anthropic APIs, who needs architecture review and pattern-matching from someone who has actually shipped these systems.

This client found you because of what you publish on danielflugger.com. The inbound is the qualification. Cold outreach for advisory at this price point is the wrong model and the wrong signal.

Scope

- 2 hours/month structured — one deep strategy session, not two lighter ones
- Async channel for urgent architectural decisions (Slack or Linear)
- Access to both products as working reference material
- No deliverables. No project work. No implementation. Advisory only. Stated clearly from day one.

Why $10,000 and not less

$3,500–5,000 attracts people who are still deciding whether they want an advisor. $10,000 attracts people who have already decided and are choosing between advisors. The price does the qualification work before the first conversation happens. At $10K/month, the meeting is about fit, not persuasion.

One slot at $10,000 is $120,000 ARR from a single relationship consuming 6–8 hours per month. That is the bridge that removes financial pressure from IDist development and the publishing layer without consuming the time that makes both possible.

> *The waiting list that forms when the slot is full is its own signal. 'Currently full — join the waitlist' on danielflugger.com/advisory is worth more than any credential on a services page. The goal is to replace this slot with product revenue as fast as possible.*

6. The Technical Stack — Everything Decided

No evaluation required. These decisions are made. The stack is sovereign, all costs are covered by GCP credits during the build phase, and every component is owned not rented. Ghost is the CMS layer inside the stack — an implementation decision, not a brand affiliation.

Component	Decision
CMS / publishing	Ghost 6.0 self-hosted. MIT licensed. 0% revenue cut. All features unlocked. Non-profit stewarded. Implementation choice, not brand.
Hosting	GCP Compute Engine e2-small ($12–15/month from GCP credits). Ubuntu 24.04. Ghost CLI.
Database	SQLite — Ghost native default. No Cloud SQL. Automated backup to Cloud Storage via cron.
Email delivery	Mailgun or Brevo — buyer choice with decision framework provided. Both deliver custom @domain.com sending.

Payments	Lemon Squeezy (default) or Stripe — buyer choice with decision framework provided.
Analytics	Umami self-hosted (free, Docker) or Plausible ($9/month). Both privacy-respecting, no Google.
Publishing workflow	Claude Code → Ghost Admin API. Ghost MCP server (~150 lines) as native Claude Code tool.
Provenance	GPG-signed commits to private GitHub repo. Webhook fires on Ghost publish. ~200 lines Claude Code.
AI discoverability	JSON-LD Person + Article schema in Ghost theme. llms.txt at root. Manual, 30 minutes to configure.
Distribution	Ghost 6.0 ActivityPub — publish once, syndicate to Bluesky/Mastodon/Threads natively.
Static credibility layer	Firebase Hosting — existing danielflugger.com static HTML. Keep as is.
Product delivery	Lemon Squeezy license key triggers private GitHub repo invite automatically on purchase.
Private knowledge	Obsidian + Ollama local + SQLite vector store. Zero cloud, zero cost, total privacy.

7. GitHub Strategy

GitHub is a discovery layer, not a development platform. Every public repo is written for the person who arrives via an LLM recommendation. The profile is the store window.

danielflugger/danielflugger	Public profile repo. Well-crafted README. Three most recent Ghost posts auto-updated via GitHub Actions on publish. Domain front and center.
danielflugger/build-before-you-need-to	Private. Product 1 system repo. Delivered to buyers via Lemon Squeezy license key.
danielflugger/ghost-provenance	Private. Webhook sidecar. GPG-signed commits on Ghost publish.
danielflugger/conviction-vault	Private. Obsidian vault auto-committed. The intelligence corpus.
danielflugger/VERA	Public. Framework docs, mdBook, GPL or CC-BY. The technical discovery asset. Links to danielflugger.com.

danielflugger/veraframework-site	Public. veraframework.com source.

Every public repo README ends with one line: ‘Built and maintained by Daniel Flügger — danielflugger.com.’ The content lives on the domain. GitHub is a pointer.

8. Distribution — Where to Put Energy

Not everywhere. Concentrated credibility, not broad presence. Every platform points back to danielflugger.com. None competes with it.

Platform	Role	What to do
LinkedIn	Highest-leverage for advisory + B2B	One sharp paragraph with a link. Specific claim you can defend. 3x/week max. Never a carousel.
GitHub	Technical buyer discovery via LLMs	Maintain repos. Profile README auto-updates. No active posting required.
Hacker News	Product launches only	Show HN for Product 1 when ready. Genuine, not promotional. One post per product.
Reddit	Technical question answering	r/googlecloud, r/selfhosted. Answer real questions. Domain in profile, not posts.
Substack	Skip	Platform brand undermines your domain brand. Content lives at danielflugger.com.
Instagram	Skip	Wrong audience for $897/year or $10K advisory. Worst effort-to-conversion of any platform.

9. Launch Sequence

No simultaneous build. One thing at a time. Each step funds or enables the next.

Month 1 — Infrastructure + Advisory

Stack live. Bridge slot filled.

- Ghost self-hosted live on GCP. DNS, SSL, email delivery, payment integration configured.
- First three public posts published. No paywall. Voice established. Free member capture live.
- danielflugger.com/advisory live. One slot, $10,000/month, clear scope, waitlist form.

- Direct outreach to 5–10 warm contacts for advisory. The client comes from someone who already knows your work.
- Ghost provenance sidecar built with Claude Code. Every post signed from day one.

Month 2–3 — Product 1 Build + Free Layer

Build the system while publishing consistently.

- Advisory slot filled (target). Financial pressure reduced.
- Product 1 private repo assembled. Infrastructure scripts, provenance layer, content architecture, 72-hour onboarding sequence, decision frameworks for payment and email.
- Free member weekly brief established. Email capture building.
- Obsidian + Ollama private layer running. Louvain graph has enough nodes to navigate.

Month 3–4 — Product 1 Launch

Ship the system. First product revenue.

- Product 1 live at danielflugger.com/system. Lemon Squeezy checkout. GitHub repo delivery.
- Show HN post. LinkedIn announcement. One well-placed Reddit answer with genuine context.
- Target: 10–20 sales in first 30 days = $4,970–$9,940.
- VERA public repo updated to reference the system — open-source layer pointing to the product.

Month 5–6 — Paywall Opens

Open the conviction layer when the corpus justifies it.

- Read back through everything published. If you would pay for it: open the paid layer.
- Foundation library assembled — 7 curated posts delivering immediate value to new subscribers.
- $897/year paywall live. Product 1 buyers notified with 50% discount offer.
- Target: 50 paying subscribers within 90 days of opening = $44,850 ARR.

Month 9–12 — Compound

Products compound. Bridge becomes optional.

- Product 1: ongoing inbound from GitHub, Hacker News, word of mouth.
- Conviction layer: 100 subscribers = $89,700 ARR.

- Advisory slot: evaluate whether to renew at $10K or increase to $15K with track record.
- IDist: 12 months of parallel development, funded by danielflugger.com revenue.
- VERA: non-provisional patent filing funded by product revenue (March 2027 deadline).

10. The 12-Month Revenue Picture

Revenue stream	Conservative 12-month target
Advisory slot × 1 × $10,000/mo (10 months)	$100,000
Product 1: 40 units × $497	$19,880
Conviction layer: 100 subscribers × $897/yr	$89,700
Total	~$209,580 gross

At 100 conviction subscribers + 1 advisory slot + steady product sales, the monthly run rate is $20,000–25,000. Achievable without paid advertising, without a team, without VC, and without giving any platform a percentage of revenue. Fixed monthly overhead: under $15. Everything else is a percentage of revenue generated.

> *IDist/NYCID is not in this revenue picture. It is being built in parallel on the time and financial breathing room that danielflugger.com creates. If IDist reaches its first paying users in 2026, the danielflugger.com revenue is no longer the ceiling — it is the floor.*

11. What This Is Really About

Verification over marketing. Know the person. Sign your name to it.

The job displacement question is not coming. It is here. The people who will navigate it best are not the ones who learned to code at 50 or built a TikTok following or got a certification in AI. They are the ones who, six to twelve months before they needed it, signed their name to a domain and started building something that was verifiably theirs.

The gatekeeping and siloed suffering inside organizations is real and structural. People carry years of genuine expertise in systems that belong to someone else, covered by NDAs, attributed to company work product. When those systems shift, they find themselves trying to prove who they are with evidence they don't own. The advice they receive is always outward-facing. None of it addresses the real problem: they have not yet built anything that is verifiably theirs.

The products in this document exist to answer that. Not with a personal brand. Not with a content strategy. With a sovereign stack on their own domain, signed with their name, with a provenance layer that timestamps every claim they make before they need anyone to believe it.

The first layer of verification is always: yourself.

Before anyone else can know who you are, you have to have built the private record that makes the public signal trustworthy. The publishing is downstream of the conviction. The conviction is downstream of the private record. The private record is downstream of the daily practice of signing your name to what you actually believe.

That is the product. Everything else — the Ghost stack, the GCP hosting, the Louvain graph, the GPG signing, the Claude Code workflow — is the room you build it in. The machines can replicate most things. They cannot replicate a specific person having consistently showed up, under their real name, with real stakes, over real time. That is the scarcity. That is what the domain holds.

For us to work together meaningfully, both parties have to sign their name to what they build. That is the only layer of verification that matters now. Know the product. Know the person. The two are the same.